UPSC CIVIL SERVICES | GS PAPER I | MODERN INDIAN HISTORY

Seq 25 — Cumulative Consolidation Test-First, Repair-Only

Spectrum Ch. 1–32 · Topics 1–24 · one session · no new reading

Your tracker's instruction: "No new reading. Retrieve timelines, maps, comparison grids and recurring analytical themes; repair only weak areas." Completion evidence: "one closed-book master map, one 250-word answer and a 20-question mixed recall test."

How this packet works. Sections 0–4 are tests. Everything after the red "keys" banner (Sections 5–9) is keys and repair material — do not open it until each test is done. You test first, mark lucky guesses as wrong, cluster your errors by **type** (not by chapter), repair only those clusters with a time cap, then re-test with the framing changed. This is the method that rescued your Polity consolidation; it is applied here to the whole Modern History syllabus.

0 THE RUN SHEET — SUN 15 NOV 2026

Block	Time	Task	Materials
1	25 min	**20-question mixed recall test**, closed book. Tick a confidence for every answer: **S** sure, **U** unsure, **G** guess.	Section 1
2	20 min	**Closed-book master map.** Fill the blank metro from memory: stations per line, zone by zone.	The A3 Blank Metro sheet; Section 2
3	20 min	**One 250-word answer**, timed: 5 min plan, 15 min write.	Section 3
4	15 min	**Retrieval grids.** Fill as many cells as you can in the six blank comparison grids.	Section 4
5	10 min	**Mark everything.** Test against Section 5; map against the Metro poster; answer against the rubric; grids against Section 7.	Keys (Sections 5–7)
6	25 min	**Repair only.** Log errors by type; open only the revision sheet for that topic; 5 minutes per cluster, then stop.	Section 9; your revision sheets
7	10 min	**Re-test with changed framing** — the prompts in Section 9.	Section 9

Total about 2 hr 05 min. If short of time, cut Block 4 first, never Block 6. Lucky guesses (G that happened to be right) count as **wrong**.

Candid verdict — where the marks are. Across GS-I Mains 2013–2026 there are **39 pre-1947 Modern History questions**. Ten of them are about Gandhian mass politics and its many voices; eight about the colonial state; five each about the colonial economy and personalities. Early nationalism, reform and the endgame share the rest. So today's answer practice targets the bridge between early and mass nationalism, and the theme engine in Section 8 maps all 39 questions so you can see which answer frames you already own.

1 BLOCK 1 — 20-QUESTION MIXED RECALL TEST (25 MIN)

All twenty are real UPSC Prelims questions (2014–2025), interleaved across eras on purpose. Write your answer and confidence in the grid at the end.

1. **(2018)** Which one of the following statements does **not** apply to the system of Subsidiary Alliance introduced by Lord Wellesley? (a) To maintain a large standing army at other's expense (b) To keep India safe from Napoleonic danger (c) To secure a fixed income for the Company (d) To establish British paramountcy over the Indian States
2. **(2018)** Which one of the following is a very significant aspect of the Champaran Satyagraha? (a) Active all-India participation of lawyers, students and women (b) Active involvement of Dalit and Tribal communities (c) Joining of peasant unrest to India's National Movement (d) Drastic decrease in the cultivation of plantation and commercial crops
3. **(2022)** In the Government of India Act 1919, which of the following were "Reserved" subjects? 1. Administration of Justice 2. Local Self-Government 3. Land Revenue 4. Police — (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2, 3 and 4 (c) 1, 3 and 4 (d) 1, 2 and 4
4. **(2020)** "Ulgulan" or the Great Tumult is the description of: (a) the Revolt of 1857 (b) the Mappila Rebellion of 1921 (c) the Indigo Revolt of 1859–60 (d) Birsa Munda's Revolt of 1899–1900
5. **(2016)** 'Swadeshi' and 'Boycott' were adopted as methods of struggle for the first time during the (a) agitation against the Partition of Bengal (b) Home Rule Movement (c) Non-Cooperation Movement (d) visit of the Simon Commission
6. **(2022)** Cripps Mission: 1. The Constituent Assembly would have members nominated by the Provincial Assemblies as well as the Princely States. 2. Any Province not prepared to accept the new Constitution would have the right to sign a separate agreement with Britain regarding its future status. — (a) 1 only (b) 2 only (c) both (d) neither
7. **(2025)** Raja Rammohun Roy: I. He possessed great love and respect for the traditional philosophical systems of the East. II. He desired his countrymen to accept the rational and scientific approach and the principle of human dignity and social equality of all men and women. — (a) I only (b) II only (c) both (d) neither
8. **(2020)** Which correctly explains the impact of the Industrial Revolution on India during the first half of the nineteenth century? (a) Indian handicrafts were ruined (b) Machines were introduced in Indian textiles in large numbers (c) Railway lines were laid in many parts (d) Heavy duties were imposed on British imports
9. **(2022)** Who was/were actively associated with the Ghadar Party? 1. Barindra Kumar Ghosh 2. Jogesh Chandra Chatterjee 3. Rash Behari Bose — (a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 only (c) 1 and 3 (d) 3 only
10. **(2025)** Subsequent to which event did Gandhiji decide to include the upliftment of 'Harijans' in his political and social programme? (a) The Poona Pact (b) The Gandhi–Irwin Pact (c) Arrest of Congress leaders in Quit India (d) The Government of India Act 1935
11. **(2018)** Santhal Uprising — measures taken afterwards: 1. The territories called 'Santhal Parganas' were created. 2. It became illegal for a Santhal to transfer land to a non-Santhal. — (a) 1 only (b) 2 only (c) both (d) neither
12. **(2018)** In 1920, which of the following changed its name to "Swarajya Sabha"? (a) All India Home Rule League (b) Hindu Mahasabha (c) South Indian Liberal Federation (d) Servants of India Society
13. **(2018)** Wood's Despatch: 1. Grants-in-aid introduced. 2. Universities recommended. 3. English as medium of instruction at all levels recommended. — (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only (c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3
14. **(2021)** 8 August 1942: (a) the Quit India Resolution was adopted by the AICC (b) the Viceroy's Executive Council was expanded (c) Congress ministries resigned in seven provinces (d) Cripps proposed full Dominion Status after the war
15. **(2017)** Pairs: 1. Radhakanta Deb — first President of the British Indian Association 2. Gazulu Lakshminarasu Chetty — founder of the Madras Mahajana Sabha 3. Surendranath Banerjee — founder of the Indian Association — (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 3 only (c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3
16. **(2015)** Congress Socialist Party: 1. It advocated boycott of British goods and evasion of taxes. 2. It wanted to establish the dictatorship of the proletariat. 3. It advocated separate electorates for minorities and oppressed classes. — (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only (c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) none

17. **(2021)** Shah Nawaz Khan, Prem Kumar Sehgal and Gurbaksh Singh Dhillon are remembered as (a) leaders of Swadeshi and Boycott (b) members of the Interim Government (c) members of the Drafting Committee (d) officers of the Indian National Army
18. **(2025)** Non-Cooperation Programme — how many were part of it? I. Boycott of law-courts and foreign cloth II. Strict non-violence III. Retention of titles and honours without using them in public IV. Panchayats for settling disputes — (a) only one (b) only two (c) only three (d) all four
19. **(2014)** The Radcliffe Committee was appointed to (a) solve the minorities problem (b) give effect to the Independence Bill (c) delimit the boundaries between India and Pakistan (d) enquire into riots in East Bengal
20. **(2020)** The Rakhmabai case of 1884 revolved around: 1. women's right to education 2. age of consent 3. restitution of conjugal rights — (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only (c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Q	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
Ans																				
S/U/G																				

2 BLOCK 2 — CLOSED-BOOK MASTER MAP (20 MIN)

- Use the **A3 Blank Metro** sheet. It shows the six lines, the seven fare zones and the five gold interchange bands — and, in each line-and-zone cell, how many stations belong there.
- Write the stations from memory as **year + name**. Do not look at anything.
- Then mark against the Metro poster (Seq 25, already in Notion and GitHub). Score each line out of its total and write the scores in the box on the sheet.
- **Pass mark:** 70 per cent per line. Any line below 50 per cent becomes a repair cluster in Block 6.

3 BLOCK 3 — ONE 250-WORD ANSWER (20 MIN)

> **GS-I 2021, 15 marks, 250 words:** "To what extent did the role of the Moderates prepare a base for the wider freedom movement? Comment."

Why this question: it forces the synthesis your tracker asks for — it starts in 1885 and can only be answered by showing what the Swadeshi, Gandhian and constitutional phases inherited. It also sits on the topic you studied longest ago (Seq 8).

Plan in 5 minutes using your five-part spine — context, course, actors and ideas, outcomes, historiography. **Write in 15.** Do not look at the rubric (Section 6) until you finish.

Planning box — verdict line, four or five body points with one anchor each, one qualification, the close.

4 BLOCK 4 — SIX BLANK RETRIEVAL GRIDS (15 MIN)

Fill what you can. Blank cells are your repair list. Keys in Section 7.

G1 · Three phases of nationalist politics

	Moderates	Extremists	Gandhians
Period · leaders			
Goal			
Method			
Social base			
Legacy			

G2 · Three mass movements

	Non-Cooperation	Civil Disobedience	Quit India
Dates · trigger			
Programme			
New social base			
How it ended			
Result			

G3 · The constitutional ladder

	1909 Morley–Minto	1919 Montford	1935 Act
Legislature			
Executive			
Electorates			
Significance			

G4 · Three British plans

	Cripps 1942	Cabinet Mission 1946	Mountbatten 1947
Status offered			
Constituent Assembly			
Provinces · princes			
Fate			

G5 · Three leaders (2015, 2016 Mains)

	Gandhi	Bose	Ambedkar
Goal			
Method			
Key moment			
Common ground			

G6 · Three waves of revolutionary nationalism

	First wave 1897–1918	Second wave 1924–31	INA 1942–45
Organisations			
Ideology			
Signature actions			
Legacy			

KEYS AND REPAIR MATERIAL — OPEN ONLY AFTER BLOCKS 1–4 ARE DONE

5 TEST KEY — WITH TOPIC AND ERROR TYPE

Error types: **F** fact or attribution · **Ch** chronology · **P** precision (statement traps) · **C** cause or purpose. The Seq column tells you which revision sheet to open in Block 6.

Q	Key	Seq	Type	Why — the one line to repair
1	**c**	4	C	Subsidiary alliance cost the *ally*, not a fixed Company income; its aims were army at others' expense, Napoleon, paramountcy
2	**c**	12	C	Champaran joined peasant unrest (tinkathia) to the national movement
3	**c**	21	P	Reserved: justice, police, land revenue (also finance); local self-government was **transferred**
4	**d**	5	F	Ulgulan = Birsa Munda, 1899–1900 (→ Chotanagpur Tenancy Act 1908)
5	**a**	9	Ch	Swadeshi and boycott began with the anti-Partition agitation (7 August 1905)
6	**b**	18	P	The Cripps assembly was to be **elected** by provincial assemblies (princes nominated); provinces could opt out
7	**c**	7	P	Rammohun valued Eastern philosophy **and** wanted reason, dignity and equality
8	**a**	22	Ch	First half of the 19th century = handicrafts ruined; machines and railways came later
9	**d**	10	F	Rash Behari Bose — Ghadar (1915 plan); Barindra — Jugantar; Jogesh Chatterjee — HRA
10	**a**	15	Ch	After the Poona Pact (1932): Harijan Sevak Sangh, *Harijan* (1933)
11	**c**	5	F	Santhal Parganas created; land transfer to non-Santhals barred
12	**a**	11	F	All India Home Rule League → Swarajya Sabha (1920)
13	**a**	23	P	Wood: grants-in-aid and universities yes; English only at higher levels
14	**a**	18	Ch	8 August 1942: AICC adopts Quit India at Bombay (Gowalia Tank)
15	**b**	8	F	Lakshminarasu Chetty founded the Madras Native Association (1852); Madras Mahajana Sabha (1884) was Viraraghavachari, G. Subramania Iyer, Ananda Charlu
16	**d**	16	P	CSP (1934): socialism within Congress — none of the three statements
17	**d**	19	F	INA officers of the Red Fort trials (1945)
18	**c**	13	P	Titles were to be **surrendered**, not retained — so three of the four
19	**c**	20	F	Radcliffe drew the India–Pakistan boundaries
20	**b**	7	P	Rakhmabai: age of consent and restitution of conjugal rights — led to the Age of Consent Act 1891

Read your score by type, not total. Several **P** errors mean you know the topic but misread statements — repair by re-reading stems, not notes. Several **F** errors in one Seq mean that topic needs its revision sheet. **Ch** errors: redraw the Metro line. **C** errors: rehearse the "why" lines in Section 8.

6 BLOCK 3 — RUBRIC AND MODEL ANSWER

What the examiner rewards	Marks	Did you?
A verdict in the first two lines — "laid the base, but their method had to be replaced"	2	
Four contributions, each with an anchor (Congress 1885; drain — Naoroji, Dutt; council demands → 1892, 1909, 1919; Gokhale and the Servants of India Society)	6	
The limits — narrow base, petitions, faith in British justice; the Extremist critique (Aurobindo's "New Lamps for Old")	3	
Explicit links forward — Swadeshi, Gandhi's khadi, Karachi rights (1931)	2	
A balanced conclusion with one historian	2	

> The Moderates (1885–1905) did not win freedom, but they built the platform on which every later phase stood — even though their methods had to be abandoned before the movement could become a mass one.
>
> **An all-India platform.** The Congress brought provinces, communities and languages into one annual forum and made "India" a political unit above region.
>
> **The economic indictment.** Naoroji, Ranade and R. C. Dutt exposed the drain and deindustrialisation. This destroyed the claim of benevolent rule and became the intellectual basis of Swadeshi and, later, of Gandhi's khadi.
>
> **Political education and constitutional demands.** Through the press and petitions they popularised expanded councils, Indianisation of the services, civil liberties and lower military spending — demands that matured through the Acts of 1892, 1909 and 1919 and into the Karachi rights resolution of 1931.
>
> **Secular, liberal nationalism and its cadre.** Gokhale — whom Gandhi called his political guru — and his Servants of India Society trained public workers in secular, constitutional politics.
>
> **The limits.** Their base was narrow and urban; "prayer, petition and protest" depended on British goodwill; Aurobindo's "New Lamps for Old" (1893) mocked it as mendicancy. Swadeshi and the Gandhian movements succeeded by going to the masses.
>
> The Moderates supplied the ideas, the institution and the economic case; the Extremists and Gandhi supplied the method and the masses. Bipan Chandra credits them with laying the movement's ideological foundations — a base, not a building.

About 255 words.

7 THE SIX GRIDS — FILLED

G1 · Three phases of nationalist politics

	Moderates	Extremists	Gandhians
Period · leaders	1885–1905 · Naoroji, Pherozeshah Mehta, Gokhale, Surendranath, Ranade	1905–1918 · Tilak, Lajpat Rai, Bipin Chandra Pal, Aurobindo	1917–1947 · Gandhi, Nehru, Patel, Rajendra Prasad, Azad
Goal	Reforms and self-government within the Empire	Swaraj	Swaraj → Purna Swaraj (1929)
Method	Petition, prayer, protest; press	Boycott, swadeshi, national education, passive resistance	Mass non-violent satyagraha plus constructive programme
Social base	Urban English-educated	Lower middle class, students; festivals reach the people	Peasants, women, workers, all regions
Legacy	Drain critique; all-India platform	Self-reliance; mass methods tested	A truly mass movement

G2 · Three mass movements

	Non-Cooperation	Civil Disobedience	Quit India
Dates · trigger	1 Aug 1920 – Feb 1922 · Rowlatt, Jallianwala, Khilafat	Mar 1930 – Apr 1934 · Purna Swaraj; Simon; Gandhi's 11 demands rejected	8 Aug 1942 · Cripps failure; Japanese threat
Programme	Boycott of councils, courts, schools, cloth; surrender titles; charkha, national schools, panchayats	Break salt law; no tax, no revenue; forest laws; picket liquor and cloth	"Do or Die"; open rebellion after leaders arrested
New social base	Muslims (Khilafat), peasants, students	Women in large numbers; peasants; NWFP (Khudai Khidmatgars)	Youth, peasants, underground socialists; parallel governments
How it ended	Chauri Chaura (5 Feb 1922)	Gandhi–Irwin Pact (1931); resumed 1932; withdrawn 1934	Suppressed by 1943
Result	Mass base created	RTCs; 1935 Act	Showed Britain could not rule against Indian will

G3 · The constitutional ladder

	1909 Morley–Minto	1919 Montford	1935 Act
Legislature	Councils enlarged; non-official majority in provinces	Bicameral centre (Council of State, Legislative Assembly); direct elections	All-India Federation (never formed); bicameral in six provinces
Executive	First Indian on Viceroy's Executive Council (S. P. Sinha)	Dyarchy in provinces: reserved and transferred subjects	Provincial autonomy; dyarchy at the centre (never worked)
Electorates	Separate electorates for Muslims	Extended to Sikhs, Indian Christians, Anglo-Indians, Europeans	Extended further; reserved seats for depressed classes (Poona Pact)
Significance	Communal representation begins	Responsible government in part	Blueprint for the 1950 Constitution (2015 Mains)

G4 · Three British plans

	Cripps 1942	Cabinet Mission 1946	Mountbatten 1947
Status offered	Dominion status after the war	A united India; three-tier union–groups–provinces	Two dominions
Constituent Assembly	Elected by provincial assemblies; princes nominate	Elected by provincial assemblies by community	Existing Assembly divides
Provinces · princes	Provinces may opt out	Grouping A, B, C; princes negotiate	Punjab and Bengal vote on partition; paramountcy lapses
Fate	Rejected ("post-dated cheque")	Grouping dispute; Direct Action Day	Accepted; 15 August 1947; Radcliffe Line

G5 · Three leaders

	Gandhi	Bose	Ambedkar
Goal	Swaraj as moral and village self-rule	Complete independence first; a planned socialist state	Social democracy; annihilation of caste
Method	Non-violent mass satyagraha; constructive work	Militant mass action; armed struggle (INA); foreign alliances	Constitutional politics, law, separate representation
Key moment	Dandi 1930	Tripuri 1939; Azad Hind 1943	Round Table; Poona Pact 1932; Constitution
Common ground	Freedom with justice for the downtrodden — the 2015 Mains framing for Gandhi and Ambedkar; Gandhi and Bose shared the goal and split on means (2016)		

G6 · Three waves of revolutionary nationalism

	First wave 1897–1918	Second wave 1924–31	INA 1942–45
Organisations	Anushilan, Jugantar, Abhinav Bharat, India House, Ghadar	HRA (1924) → HSRA (1928); Chittagong group	INA (Mohan Singh 1942; Bose 1943); Azad Hind Government
Ideology	Religious nationalism; individual heroism	Socialism; secular; mass appeal through trials	Military liberation; all-India, all-community
Signature actions	Chapekars 1897; Muzaffarpur 1908; Delhi bomb 1912; Ghadar 1915	Kakori 1925; Saunders 1928; Assembly bomb 1929; Chittagong 1930	Imphal–Kohima 1944; Red Fort trials 1945
Legacy	Courage; martyrdom	Bhagat Singh as national symbol	Shook the Indian Army's loyalty → 1946 RIN mutiny

8 THE THEME ENGINE — ALL 39 PRE-1947 MAINS QUESTIONS

Every GS-I Modern History question from 2013 to 2026 sorted into eight recurring themes. If you own the frame, you own every question in the row.

Theme · count	Questions (year — short form)	The frame that answers all of them
1 · The colonial state · 8	2022 why Company armies won · 2017 fragmented 18th-century polity · 2014 Panipat · 2013 Dalhousie · 2016 1857 as policy watershed · 2020 Curzon · 2015 1935 Act and the Constitution · 2026 Macaulay	Conquest by disunity plus discipline and money → a state that changed allies after 1857, not aims → constitutional concessions as control (1909, 1919, 1935)

Theme · count	Questions (year — short form)	The frame that answers all of them
2 · Colonial economy · 5	2024 Industrial Revolution and handicrafts · 2022 famines · 2018 indenture · 2017 artisans and the rural economy · 2014 economic policies	Three stages (plunder, market, capital) → land revenue engine → ruralisation → drain → famine; qualify with enclaves
3 · Resistance before nationalism · 2	2019 1857 as culmination of local rebellions · 2023 colonial rule and tribals	Common root in land, forest and revenue; local, kin-based leadership; continuity into 1857 and into Kisan Sabhas
4 · Reform and identity · 4	2025 Phule and the subalterns · 2021 Young Bengal and Brahmo Samaj · 2019 Renaissance and national identity · 2017 the women's question	Reason and reform → pride in a reformed past → press and English education carry it into politics → limits: elite, caste
5 · Early nationalism · 3	2021 Moderates' base · 2017 why the Moderates failed · 2014 world developments behind anti-colonialism	Platform, drain, constitutional demands; narrow base; Extremist critique; external inspiration (Japan 1905, Russia 1917, Ireland)
6 · Gandhian mass politics · 10	2026 masses mobilised · 2024 Quit India events and results · 2021 constructive programmes · 2020 1920s ideological strands · 2019 many voices · 2017 new objectives since the 1920s · 2016 women · 2013 women · 2015 independence without Gandhi · 2018 Gandhi's relevance	Satyagraha plus constructive work → each movement adds a social base (G2) → the left and Kisan Sabhas widen it → Karachi and Faizpur add socio-economic aims
7 · Personalities · 5	2023 Gandhi and Tagore · 2016 Bose and Gandhi · 2015 Gandhi and Ambedkar · 2013 foreigners · 2013 Azad	Shared goal, different means (G5); place each in a phase; one concrete moment each
8 · Endgame · 2	2019 British power complicating the transfer · 2014 the naval mutiny	Cripps → Wavell → Cabinet Mission → Mountbatten (G4); divide and rule as policy; INA and RIN end the army's loyalty

9 BLOCK 6–7 — REPAIR PROTOCOL AND RE-TEST

The rules

- Count errors by type (F, Ch, P, C) across the test, map and grids. Lucky guesses count.
- Cluster: group errors that share a **type and a topic**. Ignore isolated slips in strong areas.
- Repair: for each cluster, open **only** that topic's revision sheet. **5 minutes, then stop.** Write one corrected line per error in the log.
- Re-test with the framing changed — below. Do not re-test with the same question.

Error log

#	Type	Seq	What I got wrong	The corrected line

Re-test prompts — changed framing (10 min)

Format	Prompt	Answer
Name the Viceroy	Vernacular Press Act · Ilbert Bill · Partition of Bengal · Rowlatt Act · Gandhi–Irwin Pact · August Offer · Quit India	Lytton · Ripon · Curzon · Chelmsford · Irwin · Linlithgow · Linlithgow
Outcome → movement	Tenancy Act 1885 · Relief Act 1879 · Santhal Parganas · Chotanagpur Tenancy Act 1908 · Champaran Agrarian Act 1918	Pabna · Deccan Riots · Santhal hul · Birsa's Ulgulan · Champaran
Put in order	Lucknow Pact · Surat split · Montagu Declaration · Komagata Maru · Rowlatt Act	Surat 1907 → Komagata Maru 1914 → Lucknow 1916 → Montagu 1917 → Rowlatt 1919
Who said it	"microscopic minority" · "post-dated cheque" · "Do or Die" · "Swaraj is my birthright" · "Sedition has become my religion"	Dufferin · Gandhi on Cripps · Gandhi, 1942 · Tilak · Gandhi at Dandi (2025 Prelims)
Odd one out	HRA, HSRA, Anushilan, Swaraj Party · Cripps, Wavell, Pethick-Lawrence, A. V. Alexander · Eka, Bardoli, Tebhaga, Pabna (which fought the state?)	Swaraj Party (not revolutionary) · Wavell (not in the Cabinet Mission) · Bardoli (land revenue — the state)
Why, in one line	Why did the Company's armies win? · Why did famine mortality fall after 1908? · Why did labour stay out of Civil Disobedience?	Discipline, pay and money from Bengal; Indian rulers divided · Famine Codes, railways, irrigation · Communist "class against class" line

STOP RULE. When the re-test is done, close the session. Write tomorrow's two weakest Seq numbers at the top of your Revision Tracker entry for this row — those, and only those, get a second pass.